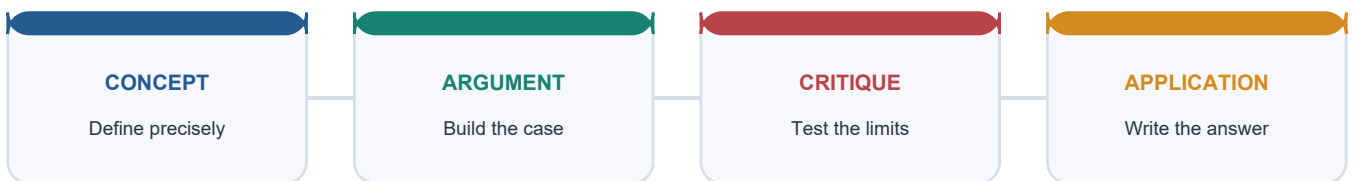


## SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

# Political Obligation, Resistance and Law - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

### LEARNING PATH



*Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.*

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Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

# CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

|                                                                            |          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Political Obligation, Resistance and Law - Solved Practice Workbook</b> | <b>4</b> |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|

|                       |          |
|-----------------------|----------|
| <b>WORKBOOK GUIDE</b> | <b>4</b> |
|-----------------------|----------|

|                                 |          |
|---------------------------------|----------|
| <b>BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION</b> | <b>4</b> |
|---------------------------------|----------|

|                   |    |
|-------------------|----|
| Practice design   | 4  |
| MCQ 1             | 4  |
| MCQ 2             | 5  |
| MCQ 3             | 5  |
| MCQ 4             | 5  |
| MCQ 5             | 6  |
| MCQ 6             | 6  |
| MCQ 7             | 7  |
| MCQ 8             | 7  |
| MCQ 9             | 8  |
| MCQ 10            | 8  |
| MCQ 11            | 9  |
| MCQ 12            | 9  |
| MCQ 13            | 10 |
| MCQ 14            | 10 |
| MCQ 15            | 11 |
| MCQ 16            | 11 |
| MCQ 17            | 12 |
| MCQ 18            | 12 |
| MCQ 19            | 13 |
| MCQ 20            | 13 |
| MCQ 21            | 14 |
| MCQ 22            | 14 |
| MCQ 23            | 15 |
| MCQ 24            | 15 |
| MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL | 16 |

|                                                           |           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL . . . . .                               | 16        |
| MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL . . . . .                               | 17        |
| MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL . . . . .                               | 17        |
| MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL . . . . .                               | 18        |
| MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL . . . . .                               | 18        |
| MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL . . . . .                               | 19        |
| MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL . . . . .                               | 19        |
| <b>PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE . . . . .</b>                 | <b>19</b> |
| VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS . . . . .     | 20        |
| ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS . . . . . | 20        |
| Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks . . . . .            | 20        |
| Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks . . . . .            | 20        |
| Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks . . . . .            | 21        |
| Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks . . . . .            | 21        |
| Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks . . . . .            | 22        |
| Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks . . . . .            | 22        |

# Political Obligation, Resistance and Law - Solved Practice Workbook

**Subject:** Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

## WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 14 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

## BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

### Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

### MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Political obligation**?

- A. the duty to obey political authority and the laws necessary to maintain political institutions (PDF p.280).
- B. law is positive law, technically valid because properly made and enforceable by authority (PDF pp.291-292).
- C. law is an instrument of social purpose and social engineering, not merely sovereign command (PDF pp.293-294).
- D. a law may be technically valid because properly enacted, yet still morally contestable (PDF pp.290-292, 295-296).

**Answer: A**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Political obligation.
- **B:** B Attaches to Analytical jurisprudence, not Political obligation.
- **C:** C Attaches to Sociological jurisprudence, not Political obligation.
- **D:** D Attaches to Legal validity vs moral legitimacy, not Political obligation.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify Political obligation by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

## MCQ 2

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Force-based obligation**?

- A. law derives authority from a higher moral order discoverable by reason (PDF pp.290-291).
- B. obedience grounded mainly in the superior coercive power of the state (PDF pp.280-281).
- C. law must be traced to social history, custom and legal evolution (PDF pp.292-293).
- D. the duty to obey political authority and the laws necessary to maintain political institutions (PDF p.280).

**Answer: B**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Natural law school, not Force-based obligation.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Force-based obligation.
- **C:** C Attaches to Historical jurisprudence, not Force-based obligation.
- **D:** D Attaches to Political obligation, not Force-based obligation.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify Force-based obligation by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

## MCQ 3

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Consent**?

- A. forward-looking punishment intended to discourage the offender (specific deterrence) or others (general deterrence) from future crime (PDF p.165).
- B. resistance may seek correction of an unjust act or law; revolution aims at larger systemic transformation and carries higher risks (PDF p.288).
- C. obedience grounded in explicit or implicit agreement to political authority, classically through social-contract reasoning (PDF pp.282-284).
- D. backward-looking punishment justified by the offender's culpable wrong and constrained by proportionality (Socio-Political Philosophy, PDF p.164).

**Answer: C**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Deterrent punishment, not Consent.
- **B:** B Attaches to Resistance vs revolution, not Consent.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Consent.
- **D:** D Attaches to Retributive punishment, not Consent.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify Consent by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

## MCQ 4

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Common good basis**?

- A. man-made law telling people what they should or should not do under specified conditions, backed by sanctions (PDF pp.289-290).
- B. deliberate, public and non-violent disobedience of an unjust law or policy, with willingness to accept penalty (PDF p.287).
- C. refusal to comply with a legal duty because conscience forbids participation, as in objection to military service (PDF p.287).
- D. obedience owed only insofar as law promotes the shared good of the community, not every command of government (PDF pp.284-286).

**Answer: D**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Prescriptive law, not Common good basis.
- **B:** B Attaches to Civil disobedience, not Common good basis.
- **C:** C Attaches to Conscientious objection, not Common good basis.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Common good basis.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify Common good basis by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

### MCQ 5

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Civil disobedience**?

- A. deliberate, public and non-violent disobedience of an unjust law or policy, with willingness to accept penalty (PDF p.287).
- B. governance through known, general, non-retrospective law and legally restrained power, not arbitrary will (PDF pp.298-300).
- C. refusal to comply with a legal duty because conscience forbids participation, as in objection to military service (PDF p.287).
- D. obedience owed only insofar as law promotes the shared good of the community, not every command of government (PDF pp.284-286).

**Answer: A**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Civil disobedience.
- **B:** B Attaches to Rule of law, not Civil disobedience.
- **C:** C Attaches to Conscientious objection, not Civil disobedience.
- **D:** D Attaches to Common good basis, not Civil disobedience.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify Civil disobedience by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

### MCQ 6

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Conscientious objection**?

- A. obedience owed only insofar as law promotes the shared good of the community, not every command of government (PDF pp.284-286).
- B. refusal to comply with a legal duty because conscience forbids participation, as in objection to military service (PDF p.287).
- C. man-made law telling people what they should or should not do under specified conditions, backed by sanctions (PDF pp.289-290).
- D. deliberate, public and non-violent disobedience of an unjust law or policy, with willingness to accept penalty (PDF p.287).

**Answer: B**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Common good basis, not Conscientious objection.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Conscientious objection.
- **C:** C Attaches to Prescriptive law, not Conscientious objection.
- **D:** D Attaches to Civil disobedience, not Conscientious objection.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify Conscientious objection by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

### MCQ 7

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Prescriptive law**?

- A. obedience owed only insofar as law promotes the shared good of the community, not every command of government (PDF pp.284-286).
- B. refusal to comply with a legal duty because conscience forbids participation, as in objection to military service (PDF p.287).
- C. man-made law telling people what they should or should not do under specified conditions, backed by sanctions (PDF pp.289-290).
- D. deliberate, public and non-violent disobedience of an unjust law or policy, with willingness to accept penalty (PDF p.287).

**Answer: C**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Common good basis, not Prescriptive law.
- **B:** B Attaches to Conscientious objection, not Prescriptive law.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Prescriptive law.
- **D:** D Attaches to Civil disobedience, not Prescriptive law.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify Prescriptive law by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

### MCQ 8

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Natural law school**?

- A. the duty to obey political authority and the laws necessary to maintain political institutions (PDF p.280).
- B. obedience grounded mainly in the superior coercive power of the state (PDF pp.280-281).
- C. law must be traced to social history, custom and legal evolution (PDF pp.292-293).
- D. law derives authority from a higher moral order discoverable by reason (PDF pp.290-291).

**Answer: D**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Political obligation, not Natural law school.
- **B:** B Attaches to Force-based obligation, not Natural law school.
- **C:** C Attaches to Historical jurisprudence, not Natural law school.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Natural law school.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify Natural law school by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

### MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Analytical jurisprudence - law is positive law, technically valid because properly made and enforceable by authority (PDF pp.291-292).
- B. Political obligation - civil disobedience is principled, public, non-violent and penalty-accepting; casual illegality is not (PDF p.287).
- C. Sociological jurisprudence - deliberate, public and non-violent disobedience of an unjust law or policy, with willingness to accept penalty (PDF p.287).
- D. Legal validity vs moral legitimacy - governance through known, general, non-retrospective law and legally restrained power, not arbitrary will (PDF pp.298-300).

**Answer: A**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Matches the record: Analytical jurisprudence is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Political obligation is recorded with the duty to obey political authority and the laws necessary to maintain political institutions (PDF p.280).
- **C:** C Misplaced: Sociological jurisprudence is recorded with law is an instrument of social purpose and social engineering, not merely sovereign command (PDF pp.293-294).
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Legal validity vs moral legitimacy is recorded with a law may be technically valid because properly enacted, yet still morally contestable (PDF pp.290-292, 295-296).

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to Analytical jurisprudence; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 10

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. Force-based obligation - law is positive law, technically valid because properly made and enforceable by authority (PDF pp.291-292).
- B. Historical jurisprudence - law must be traced to social history, custom and legal evolution (PDF pp.292-293).
- C. Natural law school - law is an instrument of social purpose and social engineering, not merely sovereign command (PDF pp.293-294).
- D. Political obligation - a law may be technically valid because properly enacted, yet still morally contestable (PDF pp.290-292, 295-296).

**Answer: B**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: Force-based obligation is recorded with obedience grounded mainly in the superior coercive power of the state (PDF pp.280-281).
- **B:** B Records the association: Historical jurisprudence is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Belongs elsewhere: Natural law school is recorded with law derives authority from a higher moral order discoverable by reason (PDF pp.290-291).
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Political obligation is recorded with the duty to obey political authority and the laws necessary to maintain political institutions (PDF p.280).

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to Historical jurisprudence; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 11

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Political obligation - civil disobedience is principled, public, non-violent and penalty-accepting; casual illegality is not (PDF p.287).
- B. Analytical jurisprudence - deliberate, public and non-violent disobedience of an unjust law or policy, with willingness to accept penalty (PDF p.287).
- C. Sociological jurisprudence - law is an instrument of social purpose and social engineering, not merely sovereign command (PDF pp.293-294).
- D. Legal validity vs moral legitimacy - governance through known, general, non-retrospective law and legally restrained power, not arbitrary will (PDF pp.298-300).

**Answer: C**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: Political obligation is recorded with the duty to obey political authority and the laws necessary to maintain political institutions (PDF p.280).
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Analytical jurisprudence is recorded with law is positive law, technically valid because properly made and enforceable by authority (PDF pp.291-292).
- **C:** C Matches the record: Sociological jurisprudence is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Mismatched: Legal validity vs moral legitimacy is recorded with a law may be technically valid because properly enacted, yet still morally contestable (PDF pp.290-292, 295-296).

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to Sociological jurisprudence; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 12

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. Common good basis - a law may be technically valid because properly enacted, yet still morally contestable (PDF pp.290-292, 295-296).
- B. Civil disobedience - man-made law telling people what they should or should not do under specified conditions, backed by sanctions (PDF pp.289-290).
- C. Conscientious objection - civil disobedience is principled, public, non-violent and penalty-accepting; casual illegality is not (PDF p.287).
- D. Rule of law - governance through known, general, non-retrospective law and legally restrained power, not arbitrary will (PDF pp.298-300).

**Answer: D**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Common good basis is recorded with obedience owed only insofar as law promotes the shared good of the community, not every command of government (PDF pp.284-286).
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Civil disobedience is recorded with deliberate, public and non-violent disobedience of an unjust law or policy, with willingness to accept penalty (PDF p.287).
- **C:** C Mismatched: Conscientious objection is recorded with refusal to comply with a legal duty because conscience forbids participation, as in objection to military service (PDF p.287).
- **D:** D Correct attachment: Rule of law is associated with this proposition.

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to Rule of law; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 13

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. Retributive punishment - backward-looking punishment justified by the offender's culpable wrong and constrained by proportionality (Socio-Political).
- B. Deterrent punishment - forward-looking treatment aimed at rehabilitation and return to law-abiding life, often by addressing social.
- C. Resistance vs revolution - some theories demand near-total obedience, some qualify obedience by rights or common good.
- D. Consent - obedience owed only insofar as law promotes the shared good of the community, not every command of government (PDF pp.284-286).

**Answer: A**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Correct attachment: Retributive punishment is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Mismatched: Deterrent punishment is recorded with forward-looking punishment intended to discourage the offender (specific deterrence) or others (general deterrence) from future crime (PDF p.165).
- **C:** C Cross-attached: Resistance vs revolution is recorded with resistance may seek correction of an unjust act or law; revolution aims at larger systemic transformation and carries higher risks (PDF p.288).
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Consent is recorded with obedience grounded in explicit or implicit agreement to political authority, classically through social-contract reasoning (PDF pp.282-284).

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to Retributive punishment; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 14

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Consent - obedience owed only insofar as law promotes the shared good of the community, not every command of government (PDF pp.284-286).
- B. Deterrent punishment - forward-looking punishment intended to discourage the offender (specific deterrence) or others (general deterrence) from future crime.
- C. Resistance vs revolution - some theories demand near-total obedience, some qualify obedience by rights or common good.
- D. Retributive punishment - forward-looking treatment aimed at rehabilitation and return to law-abiding life, often by addressing social.

**Answer: B**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Consent is recorded with obedience grounded in explicit or implicit agreement to political authority, classically through social-contract reasoning (PDF pp.282-284).
- **B:** B Records the association: Deterrent punishment is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: Resistance vs revolution is recorded with resistance may seek correction of an unjust act or law; revolution aims at larger systemic transformation and carries higher risks (PDF p.288).
- **D:** D Not this pair: Retributive punishment is recorded with backward-looking punishment justified by the offender's culpable wrong and constrained by proportionality (Socio-Political Philosophy, PDF p.164).

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to Deterrent punishment; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 15

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Retributive punishment - obedience grounded in explicit or implicit agreement to political authority, classically through social-contract reasoning (PDF.
- B. Unlimited vs limited vs anti-obligation - resistance may seek correction of an unjust act or law; revolution aims at larger systemic transformation and.
- C. Reformatory punishment - forward-looking treatment aimed at rehabilitation and return to law-abiding life, often by addressing social.
- D. Deterrent punishment - severity should not exceed the seriousness and culpability of the offence; this constrains punishment but does not by itself select.

**Answer: C**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Retributive punishment is recorded with backward-looking punishment justified by the offender's culpable wrong and constrained by proportionality (Socio-Political Philosophy, PDF p.164).
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Unlimited vs limited vs anti-obligation is recorded with some theories demand near-total obedience, some qualify obedience by rights or common good, and some deny obligation to the coercive state itself (PDF pp.280-287).
- **C:** C Records the association: Reformatory punishment is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Misplaced: Deterrent punishment is recorded with forward-looking punishment intended to discourage the offender (specific deterrence) or others (general deterrence) from future crime (PDF p.165).

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to Reformatory punishment; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 16

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Dworkin (principles in hard cases) - backward-looking punishment justified by the offender's culpable wrong and constrained by proportionality (Socio-.
- B. Reformatory punishment - resistance may seek correction of an unjust act or law; revolution aims at larger systemic transformation and carries higher risks.
- C. Unlimited vs limited vs anti-obligation - forward-looking punishment intended to discourage the offender (specific deterrence) or others (general deterrence).
- D. Proportionality - severity should not exceed the seriousness and culpability of the offence; this constrains punishment but does not by itself select.

**Answer: D**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: Dworkin (principles in hard cases) is recorded with in Taking Rights Seriously (1977), Dworkin criticises Hart's positivist account because source-based rules and a rule of recognition do not exhaust the legal standards used in hard/disputed cases.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Reformatory punishment is recorded with forward-looking treatment aimed at rehabilitation and return to law-abiding life, often by addressing social, economic or psychological causes (PDF pp.165-166).
- **C:** C Misplaced: Unlimited vs limited vs anti-obligation is recorded with some theories demand near-total obedience, some qualify obedience by rights or common good, and some deny obligation to the coercive state itself (PDF pp.280-287).
- **D:** D Records the association: Proportionality is associated with this proposition.

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to Proportionality; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Unlimited vs limited vs anti-obligation** is associated with: some theories demand near-total obedience, some qualify obedience by rights or common good, and some deny obligation to the coercive state itself (PDF pp.280-287).
2. **Resistance vs revolution** is associated with: in Taking Rights Seriously (1977), Dworkin criticises Hart's positivist account because source-based rules and a rule of recognition do not exhaust the legal standards used in hard/disputed cases.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Unlimited vs limited vs anti-obligation does not validate the second pairing.

### MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **Legal validity vs moral legitimacy** is associated with: law is the command of a determinate sovereign, promulgated in a political society, backed by sanction; disobedience must be punishable. International law is not "law" in the strict sense - at best "positive morality" - because it lacks a promulgating sovereign and enforcing political superior.
2. **Austin (command theory)** is associated with: law is the command of a determinate sovereign, promulgated in a political society, backed by sanction; disobedience must be punishable. International law is not "law" in the strict sense - at best "positive morality" - because it lacks a promulgating sovereign and enforcing political superior.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: B**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.

- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Legal validity vs moral legitimacy does not validate the second pairing.

### MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Civil disobedience vs ordinary law-breaking** is associated with: civil disobedience is principled, public, non-violent and penalty-accepting; casual illegality is not (PDF p.287).
2. **Kelsen (Grundnorm/hierarchy)** is associated with: in General Theory of Law and State - first published in English in 1945 (Harvard University Press; translated from the German by Anders Wedberg) - Kelsen argues validity comes not just from proper promulgation but from conformity to a basic norm (Grundnorm); law forms a hierarchy of norms, where each lower norm derives validity from a higher one, terminating in the Grundnorm.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Civil disobedience vs ordinary law-breaking does not validate the second pairing.

### MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Resistance vs revolution** is associated with: in The Concept of Law (1961), Hart argues Austin's coercive-command model is too narrow, being modelled on criminal law; civil law (contracts, marriages, wills) confers powers and distributes benefits rather than merely commanding and punishing.
2. **Hart (critique of Austin; structure of rules)** is associated with: obedience grounded in explicit or implicit agreement to political authority, classically through social-contract reasoning (PDF pp.282-284).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: D**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Resistance vs revolution does not validate the second pairing.

### MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Austin (command theory)** is associated with: law is the command of a determinate sovereign, promulgated in a political society, backed by sanction; disobedience must be punishable. International law is not "law" in the strict sense - at best "positive morality" - because it lacks a promulgating sovereign and enforcing political superior.
2. **Dworkin (principles in hard cases)** is associated with: obedience owed only insofar as law promotes the shared good of the community, not every command of government (PDF pp.284-286).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Austin (command theory) does not validate the second pairing.

### MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **Kelsen (Grundnorm/hierarchy)** is associated with: the duty to obey political authority and the laws necessary to maintain political institutions (PDF p.280).
2. **Political obligation** is associated with: the duty to obey political authority and the laws necessary to maintain political institutions (PDF p.280).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: B**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Kelsen (Grundnorm/hierarchy) does not validate the second pairing.

### MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Hart (critique of Austin; structure of rules)** is associated with: in *The Concept of Law* (1961), Hart argues Austin's coercive-command model is too narrow, being modelled on criminal law; civil law (contracts, marriages, wills) confers powers and distributes benefits rather than merely commanding and punishing.
2. **Force-based obligation** is associated with: obedience grounded mainly in the superior coercive power of the state (PDF pp.280-281).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Hart (critique of Austin; structure of rules) does not validate the second pairing.

### MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **Dworkin (principles in hard cases)** is associated with: obedience grounded in explicit or implicit agreement to political authority, classically through social-contract reasoning (PDF pp.282-284).
2. **Consent** is associated with: man-made law telling people what they should or should not do under specified conditions, backed by sanctions (PDF pp.289-290).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: D**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Dworkin (principles in hard cases) does not validate the second pairing.

## MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Civil disobedience means any illegal act done for a cause."**?

- A. Gauba's version is public, non-violent, principled, last-resort and penalty-accepting (PDF p.287).
- B. This file gives conceptual tests; Indian statutes, Articles and case-law belong elsewhere.
- C. Hobbes prioritizes security, Locke trust and limited government, Rousseau general will and civic freedom (PDF pp.283-284).
- D. Under a democratic welfare state, law often secures equal liberty and social welfare by rational restraint (PDF pp.296-298).

**Answer: A**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba's version is public, non-violent, principled, last-resort and penalty-accepting (PDF p.287).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "This topic is basically Indian Polity.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Hobbes, Locke and Rousseau all justify the same kind of consent.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Law always reduces liberty.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about "Civil disobedience means any illegal act done for a, not a different error from the same topic.

## MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"A valid law is automatically a just law."**?

- A. Hobbes prioritizes security, Locke trust and limited government, Rousseau general will and civic freedom (PDF pp.283-284).
- B. Legal validity and moral legitimacy can diverge; the whole discussion of natural law, equity and conscience depends on this (PDF pp.290-296).
- C. Under a democratic welfare state, law often secures equal liberty and social welfare by rational restraint (PDF pp.296-298).
- D. Gauba's traffic example shows generality and clarity do not exclude differentiated regulation by relevant situation (PDF p.300).

**Answer: B**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Hobbes, Locke and Rousseau all justify the same kind of consent.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Legal validity and moral legitimacy can diverge; the whole discussion of natural law, equity and conscience depends on this (PDF pp.290-296).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Law always reduces liberty.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Rule of law means identical rights and duties in all situations.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about "A valid law is automatically a just law.", not a different error from the same topic.

## MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Rule of law means identical rights and duties in all situations."**?

- A. Hobbes prioritizes security, Locke trust and limited government, Rousseau general will and civic freedom (PDF pp.283-284).
- B. Under a democratic welfare state, law often secures equal liberty and social welfare by rational restraint (PDF pp.296-298).
- C. Gauba's traffic example shows generality and clarity do not exclude differentiated regulation by relevant situation (PDF p.300).
- D. Legal validity and moral legitimacy can diverge; the whole discussion of natural law, equity and conscience depends on this (PDF pp.290-296).

**Answer: C**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Hobbes, Locke and Rousseau all justify the same kind of consent.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Law always reduces liberty.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba's traffic example shows generality and clarity do not exclude differentiated regulation by relevant situation (PDF p.300).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "A valid law is automatically a just law.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about "Rule of law means identical rights and duties in, not a different error from the same topic.

## MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Hobbes, Locke and Rousseau all justify the same kind of consent."**?

- A. Under a democratic welfare state, law often secures equal liberty and social welfare by rational restraint (PDF pp.296-298).
- B. Legal validity and moral legitimacy can diverge; the whole discussion of natural law, equity and conscience depends on this (PDF pp.290-296).
- C. Gauba's traffic example shows generality and clarity do not exclude differentiated regulation by relevant situation (PDF p.300).
- D. Hobbes prioritizes security, Locke trust and limited government, Rousseau general will and civic freedom (PDF pp.283-284).

**Answer: D**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Law always reduces liberty.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "A valid law is automatically a just law.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Rule of law means identical rights and duties in all situations.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Hobbes prioritizes security, Locke trust and limited government, Rousseau general will and civic freedom (PDF pp.283-284).

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about "Hobbes, Locke and Rousseau all justify the same, not a different error from the same topic.

## MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: "**Law always reduces liberty.**"?

- A. Under a democratic welfare state, law often secures equal liberty and social welfare by rational restraint (PDF pp.296-298).
- B. Hobbes prioritizes security, Locke trust and limited government, Rousseau general will and civic freedom (PDF pp.283-284).
- C. Gauba's traffic example shows generality and clarity do not exclude differentiated regulation by relevant situation (PDF p.300).
- D. Legal validity and moral legitimacy can diverge; the whole discussion of natural law, equity and conscience depends on this (PDF pp.290-296).

**Answer: A**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Under a democratic welfare state, law often secures equal liberty and social welfare by rational restraint (PDF pp.296-298).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Hobbes, Locke and Rousseau all justify the same kind of consent.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Rule of law means identical rights and duties in all situations.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "A valid law is automatically a just law.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about "Law always reduces liberty.", not a different error from the same topic.

## MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: "**This topic is basically Indian Polity.**"?

- A. Gauba's version is public, non-violent, principled, last-resort and penalty-accepting (PDF p.287).
- B. This file gives conceptual tests; Indian statutes, Articles and case-law belong elsewhere.
- C. Hobbes prioritizes security, Locke trust and limited government, Rousseau general will and civic freedom (PDF p.283-284).
- D. Under a democratic welfare state, law often secures equal liberty and social welfare by rational restraint (PDF pp.296-298).

**Answer: B**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Civil disobedience means any illegal act done for a cause.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: This file gives conceptual tests; Indian statutes, Articles and case-law belong elsewhere.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Hobbes, Locke and Rousseau all justify the same kind of consent.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Law always reduces liberty.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about "This topic is basically Indian Polity.", not a different error from the same topic.

### MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: "**Retribution means unlimited revenge.**"?

- A. This file gives conceptual tests; Indian statutes.
- B. Deterrence is an
- C. A defensible retributive theory is
- D. Gauba's version is public, non-violent, principled.

**Answer: C**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "This topic is basically Indian Polity.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "A severe sentence is automatically an effective deterrent.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: A defensible retributive theory is.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Civil disobedience means any illegal act done for a cause.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about "Retribution means unlimited revenge.", not a different error from the same topic.

### MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: "**A severe sentence is automatically an effective deterrent.**"?

- A. Gauba's version is public, non-violent.
- B. A defensible retributive theory is
- C. This file gives conceptual tests; Indian.
- D. Deterrence is an

**Answer: D**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Civil disobedience means any illegal act done for a cause.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Retribution means unlimited revenge.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "This topic is basically Indian Polity.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Deterrence is an.

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about "A severe sentence is automatically an effective, not a different error from the same topic.

## PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

## VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

No direct owned UPSC Prelims or General Studies Mains PYQ is verified for **Political Obligation, Resistance and Law** in the repository's routed ledgers. Political Theory is a GS/Prelims conceptual-support subject, and proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ ownership is prohibited. Questions owned by another UPSC paper are not imported. The six questions below are clearly labelled original GS Mains practice.

## ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

### Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

**Question:** Why is force insufficient to establish political obligation? Answer in 150 words.

**Demand decode:** the directive why requires the answer to give the grounds, not only the description, and rank them. Fix the boundary of is force insufficient to establish political obligation in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Obligation and Conclusion, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Force can explain compliance, but political obligation requires a publicly justifiable reason for obedience;.

**Model answer (137 words):**

Introduction: Political obligation asks why a person ought to obey political authority, whereas force explains only why disobedience may be costly. Core analysis: A coercively superior state can secure outward compliance through fear, sanctions and control. That causal fact cannot create a moral duty, because otherwise every successful usurper or oppressor would automatically become legitimate. Obligation requires an additional justificatory basis such as consent, protection of rights, participation in a general will or promotion of the common good. Gauba therefore separates force-based obedience from authority and later cautions that citizens encounter abstract authority through fallible officials. The defensible position is that sanctions support a legitimate legal order; they cannot substitute for its public justification. Conclusion: Force can explain compliance, but political obligation requires a publicly justifiable reason for obedience; without legitimacy, coercion produces submission rather than duty.

**Why this earns marks:** it obeys why instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Obligation and Conclusion), converts that evidence into analysis of is force insufficient to establish political obligation, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Force can explain compliance, but political obligation requires a publicly justifiable reason for obedience;. At 137 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

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### Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

**Question:** Distinguish resistance, revolution, conscientious objection and civil disobedience. Answer in 150 words.

**Demand decode:** the directive distinguish requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of resistance, revolution, conscientious objection and civil disobedience in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Resistance and Revolution, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: The four differ by target, scale, method and relation to law, so disciplined resistance cannot be inferred merely from the fact that every form involves some refusal of authority.

**Model answer (131 words):**

Introduction: These forms of non-compliance differ by the object challenged, the scale of change sought, the method used and the actor's continuing relation to law. Core analysis: Resistance targets a particular unjust command, policy or abuse and may remain inside constitutional politics. Revolution seeks transformation of the wider political or social order and therefore raises greater risks of violence, authority vacuum and unintended domination. Conscientious objection is normally a personal refusal to perform a specific legal duty that violates conscience, such as military service. The decisive test is whether refusal is limited and accountable or aims to replace the order itself. Conclusion: The four differ by target, scale, method and relation to law, so disciplined resistance cannot be inferred merely from the fact that every form involves some refusal of authority.

**Why this earns marks:** it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Resistance and Revolution), converts that evidence into analysis of resistance, revolution, conscientious objection and civil disobedience, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: The four differ by target, scale, method and relation to law, so disciplined resistance cannot be inferred

merely from the fact that every form involves some refusal of authority. At 131 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

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### Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

**Question:** Compare Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau and T.H. Green on the grounds and limits of political obligation. Answer in 150 words.

**Demand decode:** the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of hobbes, Locke, Rousseau and T.H. Green on the grounds and limits of political obligation in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Hobbes and Locke, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Their theories move from security and civic self-authorship to rights and common good, showing that consent alone cannot settle how far obedience extends or when resistance becomes justified.

**Model answer (142 words):**

Introduction: The four thinkers justify obedience through different accounts of what political authority protects or expresses. Core analysis: Hobbes grounds strong obligation in the need to escape insecurity: subjects authorise a sovereign for self-preservation and cannot casually reclaim natural liberty without reopening anarchy. Locke treats government as a limited trust for life, liberty and property; breach of trust restores a right of resistance. Rousseau locates obligation in the general will, framing obedience to public law as civic self-rule rather than submission to another's private will. Hobbes risks absolutism, Rousseau risks identifying dissenters with an allegedly higher self, Locke can understate social inequality, and Green may presume a common good that plural societies contest. Conclusion: Their theories move from security and civic self-authorship to rights and common good, showing that consent alone cannot settle how far obedience extends or when resistance becomes justified.

**Why this earns marks:** it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Hobbes and Locke), converts that evidence into analysis of hobbes, Locke, Rousseau and T.H. Green on the grounds and limits of political obligation, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Their theories move from security and civic self-authorship to rights and common good, showing that consent alone cannot settle how far obedience extends or when resistance becomes justified. At 142 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

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### Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

**Question:** Critically examine the jurisprudential debate from Austin through Kelsen and Hart to Dworkin. Answer in 250 words.

**Demand decode:** the directive critically examine requires the answer to test the proposition against its strongest objection before giving a verdict. Fix the boundary of examine the jurisprudential debate from Austin through Kelsen and Hart to Dworkin in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Austin's, Dworkin's and Core, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that inclusive positivism may recognise principles through accepted social sources, but the residual dispute concerns whether legal obligation can be exhausted by pedigree or necessarily includes interpretive moral principle.

**Model answer (235 words):**

Introduction: The debate begins with Austin's sovereign-command theory, develops through two positivist reconstructions and culminates in Dworkin's interpretivist challenge. Core analysis: Austin defines law as a determinate sovereign's command backed by sanction, a model strong on coercive clarity but weak on power-conferring rules and legal continuity. Kelsen replaces personal command with a hierarchy of norms deriving validity from a presupposed Grundnorm while retaining the separation of validity from morality. Hart grounds legal validity in a social practice of primary and secondary rules, especially a rule of recognition, and explains powers, adjudication and legal change. Dworkin argues that source-based rules do not exhaust law in hard cases: judges are also constrained by principles possessing weight and requiring interpretive fit and justification. Further development: The sequence should not be narrated as four cumulative additions to one positivist doctrine. Kelsen replaces the personal sovereign with a validity hierarchy, and Hart replaces coercive command with a social practice of primary and secondary rules. Dworkin then disputes the source/pedigree boundary itself by treating principles as legally binding and denying strong judicial discretion. Inclusive positivism may recognise principles through accepted social

sources, but the residual dispute concerns whether legal obligation can be exhausted by pedigree or necessarily includes interpretive moral principle. Conclusion: Kelsen and Hart reconstruct legal positivism beyond sovereign command, while Dworkin challenges its source-based limits; the debate is therefore an internal positivist development followed by an interpretivist critique.

**Why this earns marks:** it obeys critically examine instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Austin's, Dworkin's and Core), converts that evidence into analysis of examine the jurisprudential debate from Austin through Kelsen and Hart to Dworkin, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that inclusive positivism may recognise principles through accepted social sources, but the residual dispute concerns whether legal obligation can be exhausted by pedigree or necessarily includes interpretive moral principle. At 235 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

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### Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

**Question:** When is civil disobedience justified? Discuss with reference to Gandhi, Thoreau and the rule of law. Answer in 250 words.

**Demand decode:** the directive discuss requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of is civil disobedience justified? Discuss with reference to Gandhi, Thoreau and the rule of law in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Civil, Core and Thoreau, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that publicity and acceptance of penalty expose the protester's reasons to reciprocal judgment, while non-violence and last resort limit harm.

**Model answer (247 words):**

Introduction: Civil disobedience is a morally serious breach of law intended to correct injustice without repudiating legal order as such. Core analysis: Thoreau makes conscience central: a citizen should not cooperate personally with grave injustice merely because law commands it. Gandhi converts refusal into a disciplined public practice. The breach must be open, non-violent, principled, directed against a specific injustice, free from narrow sectional selfishness and willing to accept penalty. These conditions distinguish civil disobedience from clandestine evasion and from revolution. Its justification also depends on proportionality, the seriousness of the wrong and whether ordinary remedies are unavailable or exhausted. The 1930 salt-law satyagraha illustrates law-breaking that appeals to a wider public standard rather than private advantage. Further development: The argument must also distinguish justification from political wisdom. A breach can satisfy conscience yet impose costs on third parties, invite imitation or weaken institutions protecting vulnerable groups. Publicity and acceptance of penalty expose the protester's reasons to reciprocal judgment, while non-violence and last resort limit harm. Gauba's warning that failure to deliver every welfare promise is not by itself sufficient ground for resistance prevents civil disobedience from becoming a routine substitute for democratic disagreement. If rule of law prohibited every principled breach, it would protect arbitrary enactment from the moral standards that make legal authority worthy of obedience. Conclusion: Civil disobedience is justified only as public, principled, non-violent and accountable resistance to serious injustice, preserving respect for law while denying that legality makes every command morally binding.

**Why this earns marks:** it obeys discuss instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Civil, Core and Thoreau), converts that evidence into analysis of is civil disobedience justified? Discuss with reference to Gandhi, Thoreau and the rule of law, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that publicity and acceptance of penalty expose the protester's reasons to reciprocal judgment, while non-violence and last resort limit harm. At 247 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

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### Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

**Question:** Can legal validity by itself generate political obligation? Discuss with reference to jurisprudence, resistance and the rule of law. Answer in 250 words.

**Demand decode:** the directive can requires the answer to state the conditions under which the claim holds and where they fail. Fix the boundary of legal validity by itself generate political obligation? Discuss with reference to jurisprudence, resistance and the rule of law in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Legal, Core and Austin, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Legal validity supplies institutional order but not a complete duty to obey;.

**Model answer (236 words):**

Introduction: Legal validity identifies a rule as belonging to a legal system; political obligation asks whether citizens have a justified duty to obey it. The questions overlap institutionally but cannot be collapsed. Core analysis: Austin, Kelsen and Hart explain validity through command, normative hierarchy and socially accepted rules respectively. Their accounts secure identifiable standards and continuity without making moral merit a condition of every law. Natural-law reasoning replies that radically unjust enactments lack full authority, while Dworkin shows that principles may be legally relevant even where source-based rules underdetermine a hard case. The distinction becomes practical in resistance. Locke permits resistance when government breaches its trust; Green limits obligation by common good; Gandhi and Thoreau justify accountable refusal of specific injustice. Rule of law strengthens obligation where law is known, general, prospective and restrained, because citizens receive security and equal treatment rather than arbitrary command. Further development: Punishment reveals the same separation. Legal guilt is necessary before sanction, but it does not settle the legitimate aim or severity of punishment. Retribution, deterrence and reform answer different questions, while proportionality and fallibility constrain the state even after valid conviction. Validity creates a presumption and coordination reason, but legitimacy, rights and contestability determine whether that reason matures into duty. Conclusion: Legal validity supplies institutional order but not a complete duty to obey; obligation becomes defensible only when law is publicly known, non-arbitrary, rights-compatible and open to principled contestation.

**Why this earns marks:** it obeys can instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Legal, Core and Austin), converts that evidence into analysis of legal validity by itself generate political obligation? Discuss with reference to jurisprudence, resistance and the rule of law, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Legal validity supplies institutional order but not a complete duty to obey;. At 236 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

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